

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 4-6

Name _____

Date _____

Start at the top word. Change **one letter** on each step to make a new real word, until you reach the bottom word.

Ladder 1

C	L	I	C	K
S	H	A	D	E

Ladder 2

S	H	I	R	T
S	T	A	L	K

Ladder 3

S	C	A	R	F
W	H	I	N	E

Ladder 4

G	R	A	P	H
T	R	U	N	K

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Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

C	L	I	C	K
S	L	I	C	K
S	L	A	C	K
S	H	A	C	K
S	H	A	R	K
S	H	A	R	E
S	H	A	D	E

Ladder 2

S	H	I	R	T
S	H	O	R	T
S	H	O	R	E
S	T	O	R	E
S	T	A	R	E
S	T	A	L	E
S	T	A	L	K

Ladder 3

S	C	A	R	F
S	C	A	R	E
S	C	O	R	E
S	C	O	N	E
S	H	O	N	E
S	H	I	N	E
W	H	I	N	E

Ladder 4

G	R	A	P	H
G	R	A	P	E
G	R	A	C	E
T	R	A	C	E
T	R	A	C	K
T	R	U	C	K
T	R	U	N	K